

Know Thy Enemy (Part 4) : Baal

Antonius Torode

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In the previous part of this series, I demonstrated that the old gods are still around and active in today's age - as they have been throughout history [1]. One of the most known old gods is Baal. Throughout scripture, Baal appears as the head deity of the Canaanites and Phoenicians and tied to agriculture, child sacrifice¹, and political power²[2]. Baal is referenced about 80 times in the old testament alone. The context is almost always that of spiritual adultery and apostasy³[2]. This framing of Baal is from ancient times; therefore, what is Baal's role in the modern age?

The Hebrew word *Baal* literally means 'lord' [4], 'master'[2], or 'owner'[2].

References

- [1] Torode, Antonius, *Know Thy Enemy (part 3): The Old Gods*, June 2026. <https://github.com/torodean/bible-notes/blob/main/sermonettes/Know%20Thy%20Enemy/The%20Old%20Gods/The%20Old%20Gods.pdf>
- [2] Bible Hub: Baal. Accessed 27 June 2026. <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/1167.htm>, <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/1168.htm>
- [3] "Apostasy." Merriam-Webster.com Dictionary, Merriam-Webster, <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/apostasy>. Accessed 27 June 2026.
- [4] "KJV W/ STRONGS BIBLE." <https://godrules.net/library/kjvstrongs/kjvstrongs.htm>

¹Jeremiah 19:5 - "And have built the high places of Baal to burn their sons in the fire as burnt offerings to Baal."

²There is a constant theme in the scriptures of entire nations bending to and worshiping Baal. An example being Judges 2:11-13 - "Then the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the Lord, and served the Baals" ... "They forsook the Lord and served Baal and the Ashtoreths."

³"An act of refusing to continue to follow, obey, or recognize a religious faith" [3]